

IT Support Troubleshooting Template — Simulated Enterprise IT Support Lab

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Introduction

This document serves as a reusable troubleshooting template for IT support technicians handling helpdesk tickets in an enterprise environment. The template is designed to ensure a consistent, structured, and professional approach to every support request regardless of the issue type. Following a standardised methodology reduces resolution time, improves documentation quality, and ensures no troubleshooting steps are missed.

Section 1: Ticket Intake

When a new support request is received, the technician should begin by gathering all relevant information from the user before attempting any resolution. The technician should record the full name of the user, their department, their device name or hostname, the date and time the issue was reported, and a clear description of the problem in the user's own words. The technician should also ask the user whether anything changed recently on their system such as new software installations, Windows updates, or password changes, as this information is often critical to identifying the root cause quickly.

Section 2: Issue Classification

Once the initial information has been gathered, the technician should classify the ticket by category and priority. Categories used in this lab environment include Network, Software, Hardware, and Account Management. Priority levels should be assigned as High for issues that completely prevent the user from working, Medium for issues that impact productivity but allow partial working, and Low for minor issues or requests that do not affect daily operations. Correct classification ensures tickets are routed and resolved in the right order.

Section 3: Initial Response

The technician should send an acknowledgement to the user as soon as the ticket is created. The response should confirm that the ticket has been received, provide an estimated response time, and reassure the user that the issue is being investigated. Professional communication throughout the ticket lifecycle is essential in maintaining user confidence in the IT support team. Canned responses can be used to ensure consistency and save time during high ticket volume periods.

Section 4: Troubleshooting Methodology

The technician should follow a structured five step troubleshooting approach for every ticket. The first step is to identify the symptoms by gathering detailed information from the user about what is happening, when it started, and what error messages if any are being displayed. The second step is to analyse possible causes by considering the most likely explanations based on the symptoms described. The third step is to test solutions by applying fixes starting with the simplest and most common resolution before moving to more complex approaches. The fourth step is to document all actions taken including every command run, every setting changed, and every tool used during the investigation. The fifth step is to confirm resolution with the user before closing the ticket to ensure the issue is fully resolved and the user is satisfied.

Section 5: Common Resolutions Reference

Account lockouts should be resolved by locating the affected user account in Active Directory Users and Computers and unlocking it via the Account tab in the user properties. Password resets should be performed by right-clicking the user account in Active Directory and selecting Reset Password, ensuring the force password change at next logon option is enabled. Network connectivity issues should be investigated by running a ping test first to confirm whether the issue is on the client side or the network side, followed by checking the network adapter status and IP configuration using ipconfig in Command Prompt. Remote Desktop failures should be investigated by confirming RDP is enabled on the target machine via System Settings and that the Windows Firewall is not blocking RDP traffic on port 3389. Software installation failures are most commonly caused by insufficient user permissions and should be resolved by providing UAC elevation with administrative credentials. Windows Update errors should be resolved by restarting the Windows Update services via Command Prompt including wuauserv, cryptSvc, bits, and msiserver. Slow system performance should be investigated using Task Manager to identify high resource usage processes, followed by running Disk Cleanup to free up disk space. Shared drive access issues should be resolved by reviewing the share permissions on the server and ensuring the correct user or group has been granted the appropriate level of access.

Section 6: Escalation Guidelines

Not all issues can be resolved at the first line of support. The technician should escalate a ticket to senior support when the issue involves server-side infrastructure problems beyond basic administration, when the root cause cannot be identified after exhausting standard troubleshooting steps, when the issue affects multiple users simultaneously suggesting a wider network or system problem, or when the resolution requires access or permissions that the first line technician does not hold. When escalating, the technician should include a full summary of all steps already taken, the tools used, and any error messages or event log entries that were identified during the investigation.

Section 7: Ticket Closure

Before closing a ticket the technician should confirm with the user that the issue has been fully resolved and that they are satisfied with the outcome. A clear resolution summary should be added to the ticket as a final comment describing what the root cause was and what steps were taken to fix it. The ticket status should then be updated to Closed in the ticketing system. If the same issue recurs within a short period the technician should reopen the original ticket rather than creating a new one to maintain a complete history of the issue.